Investment Committee Phase Checklists

Printable steps, evidence, and approval gates

Use the online project overview to find your current phase page, resources, and submission workflow. This PDF is a printable reference; Canvas controls due dates, points, and the actual upload.

What BUS331 provides - and what your committee creates

BUS331 provides structured Excel workbooks and client data. Your committee completes the analysis, reaches its own conclusions, and creates its own final PowerPoint presentation.

Before you begin

[ ] Confirm your four or five team members, assign all five committee roles, and identify your three assigned clients. A four-person team assigns two roles to one member, who still casts one vote.

[ ] Create a shared team workspace and agree on a file-naming system.

[ ] Open the current phase page and read its working checklist together before beginning work.

[ ] Schedule a short committee meeting before each approval gate.

Use one project-wide Analyst Decision Log

Part 1 macro reasoning stays in the Macro Starter workbook. Part 2 reasoning belongs in the three abbreviated IPS statements. In Phase 2, open the separate committee Decision Record to record consequential recommendations, rejected alternatives, trade-offs, and verification. Retain the Phase 1 IPS statements as the client mandate throughout the project.

Formal approvals: Use the separate gate sheets for each client's Phase 2 approval. Phase 1 Part 2 requires the three abbreviated IPS statements; no formal vote or Decision Record submission is required. In Phase 3, record decisions, reservations and contributions inside the portfolio workbook; submit no separate Decision Record. Phase 4 presents the integrated recommendation.

Save as you go: Save your working project files regularly as the team proceeds, especially after consequential Decision Log entries and approval-gate work.

Access the project-wide Analyst Decision Log from the online project overview or current phase page.

Phase 1 - Part 1: Macroeconomic Analysis

Build and submit one documented 12-month macro forecast with three probability-weighted scenarios before applying it to the clients.

Do this in order

1. Open the Macro Starter workbook, assign all five roles, and save a team-named Part 1 copy.

2. Complete the detailed macro analysis in the provided workbook: review historical evidence, form a human-first interpretation, and document sources.

3. Compare the committee view with FRED historical observations and a source-dated FactSet or other external forecast or consensus where a comparable measure exists; then create bull, base, and bear scenarios with probabilities totaling 100%.

Ready when

[ ] The macro workbook documents historical analysis, source-dated external comparisons, inflation expectations, and weighted bull, base, and bear scenarios.

Required evidence

- Human-first five-year macro read with source dates

- Source-dated external forecast comparison, FRED historical evidence, and team growth, inflation, rate, and sentiment forecasts

- Bull/base/bear scenarios with probabilities totaling 100%

Team deliverables

- Completed macro starter workbook

Canvas assignment 1: BUS331 Investment Committee · Phase 1 Part 1 · Macro Forecast

Complete and submit the macro starter workbook as the Part 1 group assignment. One designated team member submits for the group; every team member verifies the Canvas receipt. Carry the submitted forecast into Part 2 and document any later revision in the decision record.

[ ] All five macro responsibilities have named owners; a four-person team may assign two responsibilities to one person.

[ ] Historical claims use the labeled series, frequency, units, and source dates; current observations are distinguished from 12-month forecasts.

[ ] GDP growth, CPI inflation, fed funds, and sentiment forecasts include a comparable external reference, source, date, horizon, and rationale when available; an unavailable comparison is explained.

[ ] Bull, base, and bear probabilities total 100%, and the weighted forecast calculates from the three scenarios.

Phase 1 - Part 2: Client Submissions

Consider RRTTLLLU for each assigned client and complete one abbreviated IPS statement for each client.

Do this in order

1. Review your three assigned client profiles and consider RRTTLLLU: risk, return, time horizon, taxes, liquidity, legal constraints, and unique circumstances.

2. Complete one abbreviated IPS statement for each client. Record your client reasoning directly in the template.

3. Combine the three completed abbreviated IPS statements into one PDF for submission.

Ready when

[ ] RRTTLLLU has been considered for each assigned client.

[ ] Each client has a completed abbreviated IPS statement.

[ ] The three completed IPS statements are combined into one PDF.

Required evidence

- RRTTLLLU reasoning recorded directly in each client's abbreviated IPS

- One completed abbreviated IPS statement for each assigned client

- Three completed IPS statements combined into one PDF

Team deliverables

- Three completed abbreviated client IPS statements combined into one PDF

Client scenario analysis

Consider RRTTLLLU for each assigned client and complete one abbreviated IPS statement per client. Record reasoning in the template. No contract or approval gate is required.

Canvas assignment 2: BUS331 Investment Committee · Phase 1 Part 2 · Client IPS Statements

Consider RRTTLLLU for each assigned client and complete one abbreviated IPS statement for each client. Combine the three completed IPS statements into one PDF in assigned-client order and submit it for the group. No contract or approval gate is required. No client interviews, signatures, separate memo, or Decision Record are required. Confirm the Canvas receipt after upload.

[ ] RRTTLLLU has been considered for each assigned client.

[ ] The PDF contains one completed abbreviated IPS statement for each assigned client.

Phase 2 - Build & Challenge

Translate the approved allocation and client mandate into a focused portfolio, select funds and ETFs as the primary vehicles, limit individual securities, resolve portfolio trade-offs, and document stress-tested residual risk and a hedge or no-hedge conclusion.

Do this in order

1. Reopen the approved client mandate before researching investments.

2. Use the structured workbooks to develop capital-market expectations and draft allocations.

3. Translate each approved allocation and client mandate into a candidate set, then compare serious alternatives against client guardrails.

4. Select 8–10 final holdings per portfolio, never more than 10, using funds and ETFs as the primary vehicles; limit individual securities to two or three total and add at most one targeted derivative hedge only when justified.

5. Build the proposed portfolios, identify the purpose and concise scorecard for every final holding, resolve overlap and concentration, and submit the locked baseline snapshot before the Scenario Reveal.

6. After the instructor releases the client-specific Scenario Reveal, apply its exact inputs, identify the client consequence, correct the required breach, and re-test.

7. Hold Gate 2: approve, revise, or reject each client portfolio and record the decision.

Definition of done

[ ] Each client portfolio traces back to an approved mandate and has a stated purpose for every holding.

[ ] Each portfolio has 8–10 final holdings, never more than 10, with no requirement to fill every slot; funds and ETFs are the primary vehicles and individual securities are limited to two or three total.

[ ] Every final holding has a concise scorecard, rejected alternatives have a concise comparison, and the team has resolved unnecessary overlap or concentration.

[ ] Any derivative hedge is limited to one targeted residual risk and documents instrument, size, cost, liquidity, trade-offs, residual risk, and adjustment or removal condition; a supported no-hedge conclusion is equally complete.

[ ] The baseline snapshot was submitted before the Scenario Reveal; each revealed-scenario breach has a documented corrective trade, trade-off, and full re-test.

[ ] Each team member has recorded one Gate 2 vote and any revision actions; all five role responsibilities are covered.

Required evidence

- Base and bear CME inputs with cited rationale

- Solver output and constraint checks for each client

- Focused candidate set translated from the approved allocation and client mandate

- Final portfolio of 8–10 holdings, never more than 10, using funds and ETFs as the primary vehicles and no more than two or three individual securities

- Concise final-holding scorecards covering exposure/role, cost and trading expenses, liquidity, holdings/sector/style overlap, diversification contribution, key risks, and client-mandate fit

- Added rationale, idiosyncratic-risk, and position-size evidence for every individual security; individual bonds are not required

- Concise comparisons and rejection reasons for realistic alternatives without full analysis of every screened name

- Holding & Exposure Reality Check for every proposed final holding, with no company-style financial-health analysis for funds or ETFs and a concise direct-security add-on only when one of the limited individual securities is selected

- FactSet Research and Evidence Log for every recommended security and material portfolio-risk input

- Integrated allocation with a purpose, owner, Phase 1 guardrail, risk contribution, and monitoring trigger for every holding, plus the Portfolio Manager's overlap, concentration, final-weight, and trade-off decisions

- Portfolio-level stress tests and the Risk and Derivatives Analyst's residual-risk evidence

- Supported no-hedge conclusion or one targeted derivative hedge with risk, instrument, size, cost, liquidity, trade-offs, residual risk, and adjustment/removal condition

- Locked baseline snapshot and instructor-issued Scenario Reveal log for every client

- Full IPS compliance scorecard and Scenario Reveal result against each approved tripwire and relevant constraint

- Before/after record, trade-off, and full re-test for every corrective trade

- AI audit entries linked to human verification

- Phase 2 decision record signed by every team member

Team deliverables

- Completed CME workbook

- Completed final-holding scorecards, concise alternative decisions, and fixed-income/equity selection record

- Baseline snapshot plus completed Scenario Reveal, remediation, IPS compliance, and re-test record

- Phase 2 decision record with client-by-client votes

Worksheet research guide

Before you select or reject a candidate, open the Research Guide tab in the security-selection workbook. The workbook tells you what to investigate for direct bonds, equities, mutual funds, and ETFs; your committee supplies the research, calculations, judgment, and decision.

Translate the approved allocation and mandate into a candidate set. Build 8-10 final holdings per client and never more than 10; eight is complete. Funds and ETFs are primary, individual securities total no more than two or three, and individual bonds are not required.

Complete the concise scorecard for every final holding: exposure and role, cost and trading expenses, liquidity, holdings/sector/style overlap, diversification contribution, key risks, and client fit. Add rationale, idiosyncratic risk, and position-size evidence for individual securities. Reject realistic alternatives briefly rather than fully analyzing every screened name.

The Portfolio Manager resolves overlap, concentration, final selection, weights, and explicit trade-offs. The Risk and Derivatives Analyst runs portfolio-level stress tests and records residual risk plus either one targeted hedge or a supported no-hedge conclusion.

Scenario Reveal and required remediation

First submit the baseline allocation, IPS scorecard, and initial stress result at the instructor-designated checkpoint. Keep that baseline record unchanged after the Scenario Reveal is released.

After release, record the packet ID, date, named client condition tested, and exact inputs in the Scenario Reveal workbook tab. Apply the released inputs without changing the client mandate or tripwire; quantify the percentage and dollar impact and identify the exposed client goal or constraint.

For every Breach, make a real security, sleeve, or weight change, explain the trade-off, and re-run the complete scenario and IPS scorecard. If a released case unexpectedly passes, report it to the instructor rather than using the result to skip the checkpoint.

Canvas submission check

[ ] Each client portfolio contains 8–10 holdings and never more than 10; funds and ETFs are primary, individual securities total no more than two or three, and no slot is filled without a purpose.

[ ] Every final holding has the concise scorecard, realistic alternatives are rejected briefly, and direct individual securities include rationale, idiosyncratic-risk, and position-size evidence.

[ ] The Portfolio Manager recorded overlap, concentration, final-selection, weight, and trade-off decisions; the Risk and Derivatives Analyst recorded residual risk and a supported hedge or no-hedge conclusion.

[ ] The baseline snapshot was submitted before the Scenario Reveal; every client allocation totals 100%, all IPS objectives and constraints were re-tested, and every revealed breach has a corrective trade and full re-test.

[ ] Every team member recorded one Phase 2 vote and can identify their recommendation, alternative rejected, key trade-off, and evidence reviewed.

Phase 3 - Build Your Client Portfolios

Use the completed economic review, client IPS statements and security research to build, optimize and evaluate three client portfolios in Excel.

Do this in order

1. Download the revised student portfolio workbook and transfer each client IPS into its Client sheet.

2. Review the provided sector and bond-category history on Reference. Enter one percentage-point adjustment for Equity, Bond and Cash; apply it to the matching category baselines and calculate downside.

3. Use STOCKHISTORY to save 61 aligned monthly closes per security and calculate 60 monthly price returns.

4. Build each client covariance/correlation matrix, enter initial weights and run constrained minimum-variance Solver.

5. Choose final weights, complete stress tests, explain trade-offs and submit one Excel workbook in Canvas.

Definition of done

[ ] Each client has 10 distinct positive-weight holdings linked to the IPS, its sector/category historical baseline and the shared Equity, Bond and Cash adjustments.

[ ] Histories, sources, covariance/correlation matrices and statistics are complete with formulas preserved.

[ ] Initial, Solver and final allocations are retained; constraints, Solver messages, risk and trade-offs are explained.

[ ] Summary includes client decisions and team contributions; the single XLSX upload is checked in Canvas.

Required evidence

- Each client has 10 distinct positive-weight holdings linked to the IPS, its sector/category historical baseline and the shared Equity, Bond and Cash adjustments.

- Histories, sources, covariance/correlation matrices and statistics are complete with formulas preserved.

- Initial, Solver and final allocations are retained; constraints, Solver messages, risk and trade-offs are explained.

- Summary includes client decisions and team contributions; the single XLSX upload is checked in Canvas.

Team deliverables

- One completed team Excel workbook: BUS331_[TeamName]_Phase3_Portfolio.xlsx

Canvas submission check

[ ] Each client has 10 distinct positive-weight holdings linked to the IPS, its sector/category historical baseline and the shared Equity, Bond and Cash adjustments.

[ ] Histories, sources, covariance/correlation matrices and statistics are complete with formulas preserved.

[ ] Initial, Solver and final allocations are retained; constraints, Solver messages, risk and trade-offs are explained.

[ ] Summary includes client decisions and team contributions; the single XLSX upload is checked in Canvas.

Phase 4 - Present and Defend the Recommendation

Present the economic review, client mandates, security research and portfolio analysis as one evidence-linked recommendation for all three clients.

Do this in order

1. Use the completed economic review, IPS statements, security research and Phase 3 workbook as your evidence.
2. Build a visual PowerPoint presentation connecting the market outlook to each client recommendation.
3. Show key portfolio comparisons, stress results, trade-offs and monitoring triggers.
4. Rehearse balanced speaking responsibilities and questions across all five roles.
5. Submit the presentation in Canvas and deliver the integrated oral presentation and Q&A.

Definition of done

[ ] Slides match the final Phase 3 workbook and identify sources and assumptions.

[ ] Each of the three client recommendations follows from the economic outlook, IPS, research and risk analysis.

[ ] Every member can explain their contribution and defend the integrated recommendation.

[ ] The team has checked the Canvas upload and is ready for the oral presentation.

Required evidence

- Slides match the final Phase 3 workbook and identify sources and assumptions.
- Each of the three client recommendations follows from the economic outlook, IPS, research and risk analysis.
- Every member can explain their contribution and defend the integrated recommendation.
- The team has checked the Canvas upload and is ready for the oral presentation.

Team deliverables

- One team PowerPoint presentation and an integrated oral presentation with Q&A.

Canvas submission check

[ ] Slides match the final Phase 3 workbook and identify sources and assumptions.

[ ] Each of the three client recommendations follows from the economic outlook, IPS, research and risk analysis.

[ ] Every member can explain their contribution and defend the integrated recommendation.

[ ] The team has checked the Canvas upload and is ready for the oral presentation.

Committee roles and operating protocol

Five committee roles must be covered by four or five members. On a four-person team, one member owns two roles but casts one vote. Every member reviews the full evidence package and prepares to defend the complete recommendation.

Client and Macro Strategist

Own client scenario analysis, the 12-month market view, IPS objectives and constraints, and the handoff from client needs to investment criteria.

Fixed-Income Analyst

Own the income, capital-preservation, maturity, duration, credit-quality, liquidity, and tax questions that shape the fixed-income sleeve.

Equity Analyst

Own equity-fund and ETF due diligence and the limited use of individual equities, including exposure, style, sector, holdings, costs, liquidity, overlap, idiosyncratic risk, and position-size evidence.

Portfolio Manager

Own portfolio integration: resolve overlap and concentration, set final selection and weights, record explicit trade-offs, maintain decision-log quality, and move the integrated recommendation to a vote.

Risk and Derivatives Analyst

Own portfolio-level risk diagnosis, stress testing, residual-risk evidence, mandate-breach escalation, and the hedge or no-hedge conclusion; do not manufacture a derivative position when no targeted hedge is justified.

AI rules of engagement

Permitted: Logic, debugging & challenge - Use AI to explain formulas, test reasoning, generate counterarguments, or surface missing risks.

Verify before use: Summaries, scenarios & estimates - Cross-check every factual claim and number against FactSet, FRED, SEC filings, or the team's workbook.

Not acceptable: Unverified decisions - Do not submit AI-generated allocations, risk metrics, citations, or client recommendations without human verification.